

2-Month Plan for the IBM Data Science Professional Certificate

Goal

Complete the IBM Data Science Professional Certificate in **60 days** with consistent daily study and project practice.

The certificate contains around **140–180 total learning hours** depending on speed and prior knowledge. ([coursera.org](https://www.coursera.org))

To finish comfortably in 2 months:

- Minimum target: **3.5–4 hours daily**
- Better target for less stress: **4.5 hours daily**
- Weekly study time: **25–30 hours**

If you already know some Python, you may finish faster.

Recommended Daily Routine

Weekday Routine (4 hours)

Session 1 — Learning (1.5 hr)

- Watch lectures
- Take handwritten/digital notes
- Pause and summarize concepts

Session 2 — Practice (1.5 hr)

- Coding practice
- Notebook exercises
- Quiz solving
- SQL/Python practice

Session 3 — Revision + Portfolio (1 hr)

- Revise notes
- Upload notebooks to GitHub
- Make mini projects
- Write LinkedIn learning posts

Important Rules

1. Never skip hands-on labs.
 2. Maintain one GitHub repository for all projects.
 3. Revise Python every week.
 4. Do not binge-watch videos without coding.
 5. Practice typing code manually.
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Course Breakdown

The certificate usually contains these major courses:

1. What is Data Science?
 2. Tools for Data Science
 3. Data Science Methodology
 4. Python for Data Science, AI & Development
 5. Python Project for Data Science
 6. Databases and SQL for Data Science with Python
 7. Data Analysis with Python
 8. Data Visualization with Python
 9. Machine Learning with Python
 10. Applied Data Science Capstone
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60-Day Detailed Roadmap

WEEK 1 — Introduction + Tools

Day 1

- Course orientation
- Create Coursera study tracker
- Create GitHub account/repository
- Study: What is Data Science? Module 1

Day 2

- Complete remaining Module 1
- Notes on data science lifecycle
- Quiz practice

Day 3

- Study Module 2
- Learn AI vs ML vs Deep Learning
- Revise notes

Day 4

- Finish course assignments
- Complete quizzes
- Write summary notes

Day 5

- Start Tools for Data Science
- Install:
 - Python
 - VS Code/Jupyter
 - Git
 - Anaconda (optional)

Day 6

- Learn GitHub basics
- Create first notebook
- Push notebook to GitHub

Day 7

- Weekly revision
- Revise all concepts
- Practice Git commands
- 1 hour Python basics extra practice

WEEK 2 — Methodology + Python Basics

Day 8

- Start Data Science Methodology
- Learn CRISP-DM

Day 9

- Case studies

- Business understanding
- Data collection concepts

Day 10

- Complete methodology course
- Quiz + notes

Day 11

- Start Python for Data Science
- Variables, data types, operators

Day 12

- Strings, lists, tuples
- Practice 25 coding problems

Day 13

- Conditions and loops
- Solve beginner Python questions

Day 14

- Weekly revision
 - Build small calculator project
 - Upload to GitHub
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WEEK 3 — Core Python

Day 15

- Functions
- Exception handling

Day 16

- Dictionaries and sets
- Practice problems

Day 17

- Loops and nested loops

- Pattern problems

Day 18

- File handling
- Classes and objects basics

Day 19

- NumPy introduction
- Arrays and operations

Day 20

- Pandas basics
- DataFrames and Series

Day 21

- Weekly revision
 - Solve 40 Python practice questions
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WEEK 4 — Python Project + SQL

Day 22

- Start Python Project for Data Science
- Learn APIs and web scraping basics

Day 23

- BeautifulSoup practice
- Extract website tables

Day 24

- Dashboard basics using Plotly
- Continue project

Day 25

- Finish Python project
- Upload final notebook to GitHub

Day 26

- Start SQL course
- SELECT statements

Day 27

- WHERE, ORDER BY, GROUP BY
- Practice SQL queries

Day 28

- Weekly revision
 - Solve 30 SQL questions
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WEEK 5 — SQL + Data Analysis

Day 29

- JOINS and subqueries
- Aggregate functions

Day 30

- Database connections with Python
- SQLite practice

Day 31

- Finish SQL course
- Practice database exercises

Day 32

- Start Data Analysis with Python
- Data cleaning

Day 33

- Handling missing values
- Data preprocessing

Day 34

- Exploratory Data Analysis
- Correlation analysis

Day 35

- Weekly revision
 - Mini analysis project
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WEEK 6 — Visualization + Statistics

Day 36

- Matplotlib basics
- Line/bar/scatter plots

Day 37

- Seaborn visualizations
- Histograms and heatmaps

Day 38

- Plotly dashboards
- Interactive charts

Day 39

- Complete visualization assignments

Day 40

- Statistics basics revision
- Mean, median, variance

Day 41

- Probability basics
- Distributions overview

Day 42

- Weekly revision

- Create visualization mini project
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WEEK 7 — Machine Learning

Day 43

- Start Machine Learning with Python
- Supervised vs unsupervised learning

Day 44

- Linear Regression
- Train/test split

Day 45

- Classification algorithms
- Logistic Regression

Day 46

- KNN and Decision Trees

Day 47

- Clustering basics
- K-Means

Day 48

- Model evaluation metrics
- Accuracy, precision, recall

Day 49

- Weekly revision
 - ML mini project
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WEEK 8 — Capstone + Portfolio

Day 50

- Start capstone project
- Select dataset

Day 51

- Data cleaning and preprocessing

Day 52

- Exploratory Data Analysis

Day 53

- Build visualizations

Day 54

- Train ML model

Day 55

- Improve notebook documentation

Day 56

- Upload project to GitHub
- Create README file

Day 57

- Create LinkedIn post about completion

Day 58

- Revise Python + SQL + ML

Day 59

- Finish pending quizzes/labs

Day 60

- Final revision
 - Complete certificate
 - Update resume and LinkedIn
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Extra Practice You Should Do Alongside

Python Practice

Daily:

- 5–10 coding questions
- Practice on:
 - LeetCode
 - HackerRank
 - CodeStudio

SQL Practice

Daily after Week 4:

- 10 SQL queries
- Focus on:
 - JOIN
 - GROUP BY
 - Subqueries

Portfolio Building

By the end of 2 months, try to have:

- 4–5 GitHub repositories
 - 2 mini projects
 - 1 capstone project
 - LinkedIn profile updated
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Best Strategy to Finish Fast

Watch videos at:

- 1.25x or 1.5x speed

Focus more on:

- Labs
- Quizzes
- Projects
- Python practice

Avoid:

- Passive watching
 - Perfectionism
 - Spending too much time decorating notes
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Final Advice

This certificate alone will not guarantee a job. What will help most:

1. Strong Python fundamentals
2. SQL proficiency
3. Real projects on GitHub
4. Consistency for 60 days
5. Building a portfolio while learning

If you maintain 4 focused hours daily for 2 months, finishing this certificate is completely achievable.

Sources:

- IBM/Coursera course durations and course structure. ([coursera.org](https://www.coursera.org))